



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

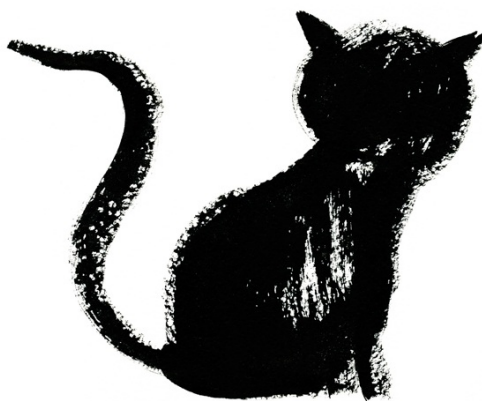
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Common sense vs. Superstition



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think common sense means?
- Do you think superstitions are just common sense? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can say and use words like triangle.
- I can pronounce words with the same consonant sound.





Let's Explore!

Sally discusses the walking under a ladder superstition and how it relates to the Holy **Trinity***.

* A "trinity" is a group of three people or things.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Our reader mailbag: Linda from Seattle writes, "Don't you think that most superstitions are just common sense? I mean, not walking under a ladder seems pretty practical to me."

Some make the mistake that superstitions are just common sense. Not walking under a ladder seems more logical than other superstitions like: don't let a black cat cross your path, saying "bless you" when someone sneezes or that bad luck comes in threes. But some make the mistake. However, there is some back story to this superstition.

As with many superstitions, the origins of the ladder come from religious belief. The belief is that God is made up of three parts, the Holy Father, the Holy Son, and the Holy Ghost. This is the Trinity. Christians believe that the number three is somewhat sacred and that the triangle formed by a ladder that leans against a building is symbolic of the Trinity. Walking through this triangle was seen as breaking the Trinity and a sin.

Thus, many Christians must take this into consideration if they choose to walk under a ladder. So you see, this superstition is not as trivial as it may seem. Although, walking under a ladder while someone is working on it may not be the best time to break the Trinity anyways, as a falling object could be the start of a bad day for you. So both things seem correct.

So the next time you are running your triathlon or riding your tricycle watch out for the Holy Trinity and workers overhead.



Let's Practice!

Readers want to know more about superstitions.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Underline each mistake. Rewrite the sentence correctly. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I'm meaning, not walking under a ladder seems pretty practical to me.

2. When they say "don't letting a black cat cross your path," that is a type of superstition.

3. Saying "bless you" when someone sneeze is considered bad luck.

4. They say that bad things are coming in threes if you believe in superstition.

5. Christians are believing that the number three is somewhat sacred.



Let's Practice!

Consonants sound the same sometimes!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. this / must / into / . / Christians / take / consideration

2. the / It / best / Trinity / break / the / not / time / anyway / be / . / may / to

3. be / the / you / of / start / . / bad / could / This / day / for / a

4. correct / things / . / seem / So / both

5. black / a / path / Don't / let / . / your / cross / cat



Extension Activity

Make a poster about your favorite superstitions.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a poster about your favorite superstitions.
- Use pictures from magazines or online.
- Use local and cultural superstitions.
- Present your work to your classmates.
- Did you all have similar things?
- Give feedback to your partners.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about manners, customs and superstitions.

☐ ☐

I give useful feedback.

☐ ☐

I present ideas in a clear and interesting way.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **common sense** (noun): the ability to think and behave in a reasonable way and to make good decisions
e.g. Don't you think that most superstitions are just common sense?
- **practical** (adjective): useful and sensible
e.g. Superstitions are just common sense. I mean, not walking under a ladder seems pretty practical to me.
- **back story** (noun): a story that tells what led up to the main story or plot (as of a film)
e.g. However, there is some back story to this superstition.
- **origins** (noun): the point or place where something begins or is created
e.g. As with many superstitions, the origins of the ladder come from a religious belief.
- **trinity** (noun): a group of three people or things
e.g. The belief is that God is made up of a trinity, the Holy Father, the Holy Son, and the Holy Ghost.
- **somewhat** (adverb): used to make a statement or description less forceful or definite
e.g. Christians believe that the number three is somewhat sacred.
- **sacred** (adjective): worthy of religious worship
e.g. People believe that certain objects are sacred in their religion.
- **sin** (noun): an offense against religious or moral law
e.g. Walking through this triangle was seen as breaking the Trinity and a sin.
- **trivial** (adjective): not important
e.g. So you see, this superstition is not as trivial as it may seem.





Learning Points

The Sound *tri-*

Consonant clusters like *tri-* are a group of two or more consonants in a syllable that are next to each other, or do not have a vowel between them.

The sound *tri-* is often found at the beginning of a word as a prefix.

It consists of the *t* , *r* and *eye* or *i* sounds.

Try saying the three sounds together, one after the other.

Practice pronouncing the *tri-* sound in the following words

triangle	trivial	tricycle	Trinity	triathlon
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Examples:

- *This superstition is not trivial.*
- *When are you running your triathlon?*
- *The Trinity is considered sacred by Christians.*

Linking Words with the Same Consonant Sound

Linking words with the same consonant sounds smoothly connect one word to the next when speaking.

When a word ends in a consonant sound and the following word begins with the same consonant sound, we don't pronounce two sounds - both sounds are pronounced together as one.

Practice pronouncing the linking words in the following examples.

<i>p-p</i>	<i>g-g</i>	<i>d-d</i>	<i>t-t</i>	<i>r-r</i>	<i>k-c</i>
step parent	big girl	red dish	get ten	wear red	dark color
Step p arent	big g irl	red d ish	get t en	wea r ed	dar k color

Examples:

- *So both things seem correct.*
- *It may not be the best time.*
- *Christians must take this into consideration*

